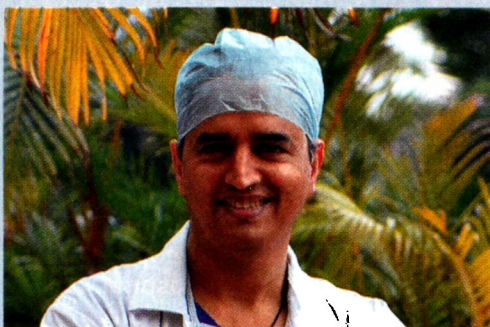


Dr Devi Shetty, NARAYANA HRUDAYALAYA

Dr Shetty's blueprint remains essentially the same: health cities with advanced technological support at an affordable cost. "Our telemedicine network has already treated over 53,000 heart patients and is now connected to 56 cities in Africa and Malaysia," he says. His Narayana Hrudalaya is the only centre in Asia to have invested heavily in the artificial heart.

"The biggest problem now is that the current healthcare players are too small. Unless a group has 20,000-30,000 beds, you cannot reduce the cost of treatment."



GIREESH GV/www.indiatodayimages.com

16%
is the rate at which
the healthcare
sector is growing
year on year

1 lakh
beds each year for
the next 20 years at
Rs 50,000 cr per year
is what India needs

60%
of the 15,393
hospitals and 80%
of all qualified
doctors are in the
private sector

Dr Naresh Trehan's Rs 1,000-crore Medanta Medicity in Gurgaon, the 1,500-bed ("Asia's largest hospital") Mumbai's SevenHills, Apollo's 200-acre wellness hub in Lavasa or the technology paradise that is Kokila Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital in Mumbai. What's more? About 15 hospital projects are slated to open this year and 90 per cent of them are multispecialty corporate hospitals funded by private equity funds, parading top-of-the-line facilities and totalling an eye-catching investment of Rs 3,415 crore. Apollo is planning 32 hospitals in two years, Wockhardt is spending Rs 400 crore in four superspecialties, Columbia Asia is setting up 15 new hospitals in India, Shalby of

SEVENHILLS HOSPITAL

Who Dr Jitendra Das Maganti of Hyderabad-based SevenHills Healthcare Pvt. Ltd in a public-private partnership with Bombay Municipal Corporation.

Where 17-acre plot at Andheri near the Mumbai international airport, with a built-up area of 2 million sq. ft. The hospital has 16 blocks divided into 11 levels.

When April 2010

What The PPP model is premised on providing five-star hospital treatment at a lower price. Has 1,500 beds, 300 critical care beds, 120 outpatient clinics, 36 modular operation theatres, 30 specialties and an exclusive floor designed with 100 luxury suite rooms for international medical tourists and VIPs.

SevenHills boasts of an infrastructure support from pneumatic tube system, HVAC, purified water system, telemedicine, track and trace system using RFID and fully covered by WiFi.

Tina Ambani

In Mumbai, a brand new hospital is emerging as a shining jewel on the city's crown. Partly because this is where the Amitabh Bachchans and Hrithik Roshans of the city throng for treatment. Partly because it's a pleasure to come to this den of luxury. Partly because it's a hospital that houses the best of technology—from intra-operative MRI suites to Trilogy image-guided, precision radiotherapy equipment.



Gujarat is opening OPDs across and beyond India, Narayana Health City is expanding to other states; DLF and Fortis are investing Rs 3,000 crore on 15 hospitals; Kolkata's Ruby General has a Rs 10-crore expansion plan; Global Hospitals of Hyderabad is charting a health city in Chennai; Max is expanding by Rs 243 crore; Hinduja's are foraying into boutique hospitals. The hospital growth saga is being written at a furious pace.

New Rules, New Deals

"I want you to give me a plan for a wellness city within three days," Dr Prathap Reddy, chairman of the Apollo Hospitals Group, asked his sprightly grand-daughter, Upasna.

When she showed him the PowerPoint, he gave her 100 days to visit the seven best wellness destinations around the world, with one condition: "You have to go to Kerala at the end of the journey." That created the blueprint of new growth for Apollo—be it developing high-end hospitals in Maldives, building the wellness city at Lavasa, or tying up with ayurveda *vaidyas* in Kerala for research on the "science of life, prevention and longevity". Reddy is once again navigating unexplored terrains, where healing, learning and rejuvenation get coupled with world-class infrastructure and modern medicine.

"There's so much business, nobody needs to fight for a piece of the healthcare pie," Reddy's affable de-